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As-Is Seller Prep Guide

Selling a home that needs work? Know your options before you list.

Every home and situation is different. Use this guide to organize your thinking, and talk with a real estate attorney or tax professional about anything specific to you.

1. Decide how you want to sell

- [ ] Do you need speed, top price, or the least hassle? Rank them. You usually cannot have all three.
- [ ] Compare options: list on the market as-is, make selected repairs and list, or sell directly to an investor or cash buyer.
- [ ] Ask for an honest opinion of value both as-is and with repairs, so you can compare net results, not just prices.
- [ ] Check the mortgage payoff and any liens so you know your real bottom line.

2. What to fix and what to leave

- [ ] Fix things that scare buyers or block financing: active leaks, safety hazards, missing or broken systems.
- [ ] Consider cheap cosmetic items that help photos and showings: cleaning, light paint, clearing the yard, fixing small obvious items.
- [ ] Leave large or taste-based projects to the buyer unless the numbers clearly justify them.
- [ ] Get a contractor estimate before you decide. Do not guess the cost of repairs.
- [ ] Ask whether permits are needed for any repair you plan to do.

3. Disclosures and paperwork

- [ ] Gather what you know about the home's history: repairs, roof, HVAC, plumbing, water intrusion, pest issues, insurance claims.
- [ ] In Florida, sellers generally must disclose known problems that materially affect the value and are not easy for a buyer to see. Ask your agent or an attorney about your situation.
- [ ] Collect permits, warranties, receipts, and manuals if you have them.
- [ ] Check for open permits or code violations. Resolving these early avoids surprises.

4. Know who buys as-is homes

- [ ] Investors and flippers: often move quickly and focus on numbers, but expect a discount for risk and repairs.
- [ ] Cash buyers: can avoid loan delays, but may still want an inspection period.
- [ ] Owner-occupants: may pay more but often need financing and may negotiate repairs.

- [ ] Decide ahead of time how you will compare offers: price, fees, closing date, contingencies, and certainty.

5. Prepare to list

- [ ] Clean, declutter, and remove personal items and trash.
- [ ] Make sure the utilities are on for showings and inspections.
- [ ] Take good photos, even if the home needs work. Honest, well-lit photos get more calls.
- [ ] Agree on showing access and how buyers can inspect the home.
- [ ] Decide your response to inspection requests before they arrive.

6. Compare offers and close

- [ ] Look at the net to you, not just the headline price.
- [ ] Check the buyer's proof of funds or financing, and the length of the inspection period.
- [ ] Confirm who pays which closing costs, and who handles title.
- [ ] Set realistic dates for closing and moving out.
- [ ] Get everything in writing, and ask questions before you sign.

7. Red flags to slow down for

- [ ] Pressure to sign quickly or to skip a written contract.
- [ ] Offers that look high but are full of contingencies or fees.
- [ ] Buyers who will not show proof of funds.
- [ ] Requests for money up front before closing.
- [ ] Anyone asking you to hide a known problem.

Next step: Not sure which path is best for your home? Contact Tony for a no-pressure conversation about your options.
Call or text **813-345-7487** | tonino.damiano@exprealty.com | toninodamiano.exprealty.com | YouTube: @tonyinvestorfriendlyrealto

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